LockIn — Technical PRD

Oct 18, 2026 · @jash · v0.1 · *"LockIn" is a working name*

How to use this PRD with Claude

Build one phase at a time from section "Build plan", and stop at each phase gate for Jash to test on a real phone before moving on.

Paste this into your coding agent at the start of the project:

```
You are building LockIn from docs/PRD.md. Rules:
1. Read the whole PRD before writing code. Build only the current phase in
"Build plan".
2. Anything marked [DECIDE] is Jash's call. Ask him before implementing it;
never guess.
3. All gamification numbers (XP values, caps, thresholds) live in one config
file, never hard-coded.
4. Secrets go in .env only. Never commit tokens. Encrypt platform OAuth
tokens at rest.
5. Every phase ends with: migrations applied, tests passing, seed data
loaded, a short CHANGELOG entry.
6. If a platform API behaves differently from this PRD, stop and report it
instead of working around it.
```

Save this doc into the repo as `docs/PRD.md` (export it as Markdown) and point to it from `CLAUDE.md`.

Product overview

LockIn is the app that takes someone from "I'm going to be a creator" to their first paid brand deal, by making consistency a game.

Who it's for: Indians starting out on Instagram or YouTube, from zero to roughly 10K followers. Not established influencers.

The problem: Most new creators quit within weeks. Posting is a big effort, results depend on an algorithm, and early numbers feel like rejection.

The core idea: Reward effort daily, celebrate results when they come, and make paid brand gigs the end reward.

- **Daily layer (effort, always in the user's control):** ideas, hooks, scripts, practice clips, posting on schedule. Earns XP, streaks and league rank.
- **Results layer (from real platform data):** view milestones, follower milestones, personal bests. Earns creator tiers that only go up.
- **Reward layer (Phase 5):** at a set tier, creators unlock paid UGC gigs from Indian brands, a SideShift-style marketplace.

What we borrow from SideShift for the marketplace: a brand pastes its website and AI drafts the brief and pay structure; creators apply; per-creator cost-per-view tracking; best organic posts reused as ads; one-click payouts; an MCP server so brands can run campaigns from an AI assistant.

North-star metric: Weekly Consistent Creators, the number of users who hit their own weekly posting goal.

Supporting metrics:

Metric	What it tells us
D1 / D7 / D30 retention	Whether the daily loop works
Share of active users on a 7+ day streak	Habit formation
Median days from signup to first verified post	Onboarding friction
Ideas that reach "posted" (%)	Whether daily practice turns into real posts
Users reaching Gig-ready tier (%)	Whether the coaching actually makes creators better

Targets get set after the first 4 weeks of beta data.

Key decisions and assumptions

These defaults let the build start now. Items marked [DECIDE] need Jash's confirmation before the phase that uses them.

Area	Default	Why	Status
Platforms at launch	Instagram and YouTube, behind one connector interface	Jash wants both; the gamification doesn't care which platform a post is on	[DECIDE] Instagram-only MVP would ship faster
Client	Mobile app first (Android + iOS) via Expo / React Native; web later	Streaks need push notifications; most target users in India are Android-first	Assumed
Backend	FastAPI (Python) + Postgres on Supabase + Redis job queue	Python suits the AI and video pipelines; Supabase gives auth, storage and Postgres in one place	Assumed
AI models	Claude API for coaching and grading; a speech-to-text model for transcripts; ffmpeg for video frames	Model-agnostic pipeline: frames + transcript work with any LLM	Assumed
Languages	English and Hinglish at launch; Hindi and regional languages later	Most Indian beginners script and caption in Hinglish	[DECIDE]
Age	18+ only at launch	Under-18 users need verifiable parental consent under India's data law (see Trust and compliance)	[DECIDE]
Pricing	Free for creators during MVP	Goal is adoption; brands pay once the marketplace launches in Phase 5	Assumed
Name	LockIn (working name)	From Jash's "lock in" framing	[DECIDE]

Core user journeys

The product is four loops: onboard once, practise daily, post weekly, tier up over months.

1. Onboarding (target: under 3 minutes to first XP)

1. Sign up with phone OTP or Google. Confirm age 18+.
2. Pick a goal ("start posting", "grow my page", "earn from content"), a niche (fitness, tech, food, fashion, comedy, education, finance, travel, other) and a language (English or Hinglish).
3. Set a weekly posting goal (1 to 7 posts per week; the app suggests 3).
4. Do a first 60-second exercise: write 3 hooks for your niche. The AI grades them. User earns first XP and day 1 of the streak.
5. Optional, can be skipped: connect Instagram (needs a free creator or business account) or YouTube. The app explains how to switch an Instagram account to creator.

2. Daily loop (the Duolingo lesson, about 5 minutes)

1. Push notification from the coach at the user's chosen time.
2. Home screen shows the daily brief: today's prompt, streak, league rank, the next idea in the pipeline.
3. User does at least one rep: capture an idea, write hooks, draft a script, or record a practice clip.
4. The AI coach responds with a score, one specific fix, and a short reaction in the coach's voice.
5. XP, skill progress and streak update with an animation.

3. Posting loop (weekly)

1. User moves an idea through the pipeline: idea → hook → script → filmed → posted.
2. Optional pre-post review: upload the edited video and get feedback before posting.
3. User posts on Instagram or YouTube natively (the app does not publish for them in MVP).
4. The app detects the new post through the connected account, links it to the idea and awards posting XP.
5. 48 hours later: a results card with views, likes, saves and a comparison to the user's own average, plus a reflection prompt ("what would you change?") that earns XP.

4. Tier-up loop (months)

1. Results sync daily. When a post crosses a milestone or beats a personal best, a celebration screen appears.
2. Creator tier is recalculated. Tiers only go up.
3. Reaching Gig-ready unlocks the marketplace in Phase 5, where brand campaigns appear as paid quests.

Gamification system

XP rewards effort and quality; tiers reward real results; nothing ever punishes a user for low views. All numbers below are starting values in `config/gamification.yaml`, tuned from beta data.

XP rules

Action	Base XP	Quality bonus	Verified how
Capture an idea	10	+5 if AI score ≥ 7/10	Must not duplicate a past idea (embedding similarity)
Write a hook (graded)	10	+10 if AI score ≥ 7/10	AI rubric
Finish a script	25	+10 if AI score ≥ 7/10	AI rubric
Record a practice clip	30	+10 if AI score ≥ 7/10	Clip uploaded and analysed
Pre-post video review	30	none	Video uploaded and analysed
Verified post on Instagram or YouTube	100	+50 if it hits the weekly goal	Detected through platform API, published after connection
48-hour reflection	20	none	Minimum 15 words
Lesson or challenge completed	15	none	In-app

Daily cap from practice actions: 300 XP. Posting and reflection XP are not capped.

Streaks

- **Daily streak:** extends when the user completes at least one rep that earns XP in their local day.
- **Weekly goal streak:** extends when the user hits their own weekly posting goal. This is the north-star behaviour and gets the biggest celebrations.
- **Streak freeze:** earned 1 per 7-day streak, hold at most 2, used automatically on a missed day.
- Streak loss is shown gently ("start a new run"), never with guilt language after a 30+ day streak.

Skill tree: six skills, five levels each. Each AI-graded action adds skill XP to the skills it trains.

Skill	Trained by
Hooks	Hook exercises, first 3 seconds of practice clips
Retention and pacing	Script structure, video review, platform retention data where available
On-camera confidence	Practice clips (delivery, energy, eye contact)
Editing	Pre-post video reviews (cuts, captions, pacing)
Storytelling	Scripts and ideas
Niche and consistency	Weekly goal streaks, posting in the chosen niche

Leagues (weekly, effort-only)

- Cohorts of about 30 users at a similar creator tier, matched by signup week where possible.
- Ranked on weekly XP. Top 7 promote, bottom 5 demote, the rest stay.
- Ladder: Bronze, Silver, Gold, Platinum, Diamond.
- Never rank by followers or views. A zero-follower creator must be able to win.

Creator tiers (results-based, only go up)

Tier	Unlocked when
Starter	Account created
Poster	First verified post

Tier	Unlocked when
Consistent	Hit the weekly goal 4 weeks in a row
Rising	One post with 1,000+ views, or 100+ followers
Breakout	One post with 10,000+ views, or 1,000+ followers
Gig-ready	Breakout + Consistent + average AI quality ⩾ 7 across the last 10 graded actions + fraud checks passed

Personal bests: celebrate any post that beats the user's own previous best views, saves or watch time, at any scale.

Anti-gaming rules

- Idea and hook XP needs a minimum AI quality score of 4/10; junk gets 0 XP and a coaching nudge.
- Duplicate ideas (cosine similarity above 0.9 to the user's past ideas) get no XP.
- Only posts published after the account connection count, and only on the connected account.
- Tier awards based on views wait for a fraud check (see Trust and compliance).

MVP feature spec

The MVP is ten modules; the brand marketplace is Phase 5. Each module lists what "done" means.

M1. Auth and profile

Phone OTP and Google sign-in, an age gate, and a profile holding niche, language, weekly goal, timezone and notification time.

- Signing up with a birth date under 18 blocks account creation with a clear message.
- Users can delete their account from settings; profile, ideas, media and platform data are erased within 30 days, while processing logs are kept only as long as the law requires (see Trust and compliance).

M2. Onboarding

The flow in journey 1, ending with a graded first exercise.

- A new user earns their first XP in under 3 minutes without connecting any platform.
- Every onboarding step except age and niche can be skipped.

M3. Idea pipeline

A board of the user's ideas, each moving through stages: idea, hook, script, filmed, posted.

- Users can add ideas by text or voice note (transcribed).
- Each stage change is logged with a timestamp and awards the XP in the gamification rules.
- A detected post can be linked to an idea automatically (caption similarity) or manually.

M4. Practice reps

Short exercises: write hooks, rewrite a weak hook, draft a 30-second script, record a 7 to 15 second clip.

- Every rep returns a score out of 10, one strength, one specific fix, and an improved example.
- Feedback returns in under 8 seconds for text reps and under 60 seconds for clips.

M5. AI coach

A named coach character (name [DECIDE]) that writes the daily brief, reacts to reps, and answers questions in chat.

- The coach knows the user's niche, language, recent scores, streak and latest post stats.
- Replies in the user's chosen language, including Hinglish.
- Refuses advice that breaks platform rules (buying views, follow-for-follow schemes) and explains why.

M6. Platform connect and sync

OAuth connection to Instagram (professional accounts) and YouTube, then scheduled syncing of posts and metrics.

- New posts are detected within 6 hours of publishing.
- Per-post metrics are snapshotted at 1h, 24h, 48h, 7 days and 30 days after publishing.
- A disconnected or expired token shows a reconnect prompt; gamification never breaks because of it.

M7. Gamification engine

Server-side XP ledger, streaks, skills, leagues, tiers and badges.

- XP is only ever written by the server as append-only ledger entries; the client cannot grant XP.
- Streaks compute in the user's local timezone; a streak freeze applies automatically.
- Leagues close every Sunday 23:59 IST; promotions and demotions are applied idempotently.

M8. Notifications

Push notifications via Expo, written in the coach's voice.

- At most 2 pushes per day; quiet hours 22:00 to 08:00 local unless the user changes them.
- Types: daily reminder, streak at risk (2 hours before day end), results ready, league result, tier-up.

M9. Progress screens

Home (daily brief, streak, league), Profile (tier, skills, badges, personal bests), Stats (post history with metrics).

- Stats always compare a post to the user's own past posts, never to other creators.

M10. Admin console (internal)

A basic web page for the team.

- Search users, view their XP ledger, reverse fraudulent XP, edit gamification config, view AI cost per user per day.

AI pipelines

Every AI feature returns structured JSON validated against a schema, so scores feed the XP engine reliably and the coach's tone stays separate from the grading.

Pipeline	Input	Output	Runs
Idea scorer	Idea text, niche, past ideas	Score 0 to 10, novelty flag, one-line angle suggestion	Sync, under 5s

Pipeline	Input	Output	Runs
Hook grader	Hook text, niche, language	Score, rubric breakdown, one fix, rewritten example	Sync, under 5s
Script coach	Script draft, target length	Score, structure notes (hook, payoff, call to action), suggested cuts	Sync, under 8s
Clip and video reviewer	Video file	Score per skill, timestamped notes, top 3 fixes	Async job, under 60s for clips
Daily brief writer	User profile, streak, recent scores, latest post stats, niche trends list	Today's prompt, one focus skill, coach message	Nightly batch per user
Results explainer	Post metrics vs user's own baseline	Plain-language summary + one lesson	Async at 48h snapshot
Coach chat	Conversation + user context	Reply in coach voice	Streaming

Video review pipeline

1. Upload to object storage; enqueue a job.
2. Extract audio with ffmpeg, transcribe with a speech-to-text model that handles Hinglish.
3. Sample frames: 4 frames per second for the first 3 seconds (the hook), then 1 frame every 2 seconds.
4. Compute cheap signals without AI: duration, cut frequency, loudness, silence gaps, on-screen text presence.
5. Send transcript, frames and signals to the LLM with the review rubric. Validate the JSON output.
6. Store the review, award skill XP, notify the user.

Grading rubrics: written once per rep type and versioned in `prompts/rubrics/`. Each rubric lists 3 to 5 criteria with what a 3, 6 and 9 look like, plus niche-specific examples. Store the rubric version on every graded item.

Coach persona: a system prompt in `prompts/coach.md` defines name, voice (warm, direct, a little funny, never shaming), language rules, and hard limits: no promises of virality, no advice to buy followers or views, no medical, legal or financial advice.

Cost controls

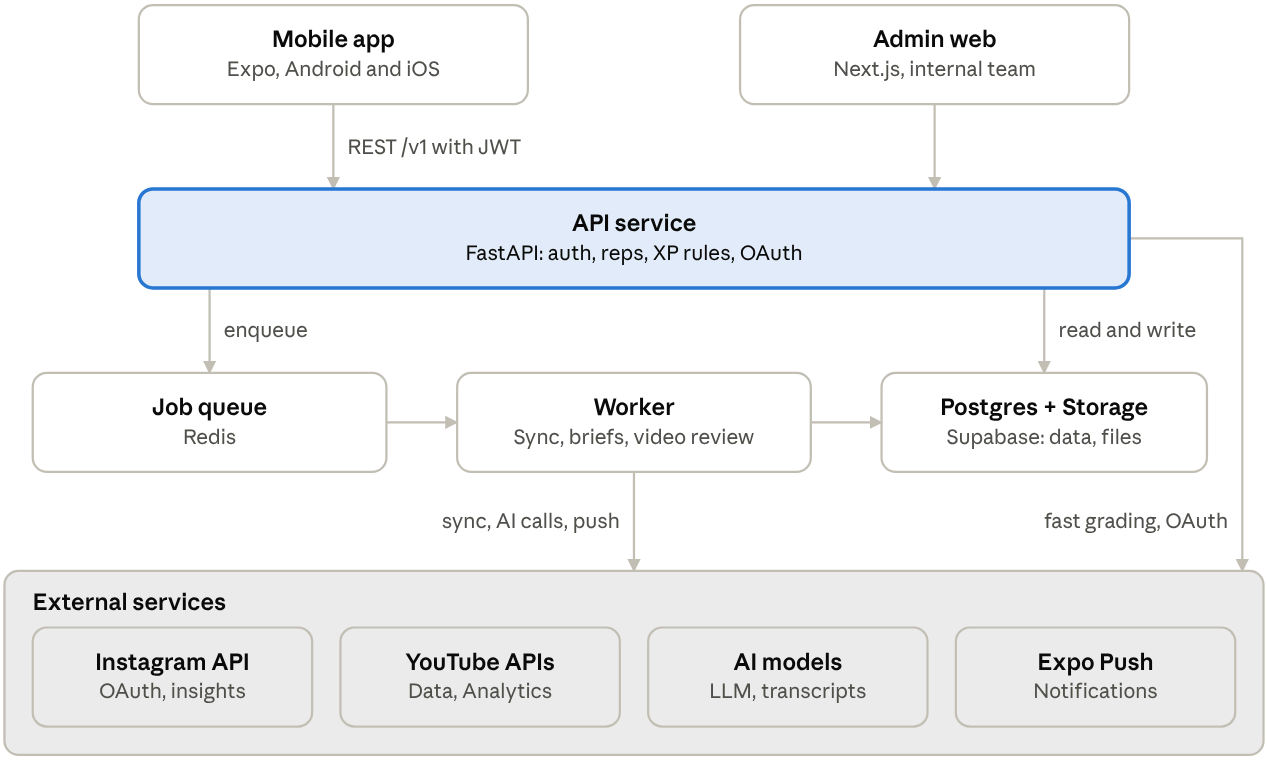
- Cache the user-context block so each call doesn't resend profile data (prompt caching).
- Use a smaller, cheaper model for idea and hook grading; the larger model only for video review and the daily brief.
- Per-user daily AI budget in config; past it, reps still earn XP but feedback becomes a short version.
- Log tokens and cost per call to the `ai_calls` table; the admin console shows cost per active user.

Quality checks: keep a golden set of 50 hooks and 20 clips with human-agreed scores. Every prompt change runs against it; scores must stay within ±1 of the human score on 80% of items before shipping.

System architecture

The app only talks to the API; anything slower than a few seconds (platform sync, video review, nightly briefs, notifications) runs in the worker off a job queue.

The API answers the app; the worker does the slow work



system architecture · 9 components

Text reps are graded inside the API call so feedback feels instant; everything else is queued.

Component	Tech	Responsibilities
Mobile app	Expo (React Native, TypeScript), Expo Router	All creator screens, recording clips, push token registration, direct media upload via signed URLs
Admin web	Next.js	User lookup, XP reversals, fraud review, config edits, AI cost view
API service	FastAPI (Python 3.12)	Auth checks, REST endpoints, text-rep grading, XP and streak rules, OAuth callbacks
Job queue	Redis with a Python job library (for example arq or RQ)	Scheduled and on-demand jobs, retries

Component	Tech	Responsibilities
Worker	Python, ffmpeg	Platform sync, metric snapshots, video review, daily briefs, league close, notifications
Postgres + Storage	Supabase (Postgres with pgvector, Auth, Storage)	System of record, row-level security, media files
AI models	Claude API; a speech-to-text model with Hinglish support	Grading, coaching, briefs; transcripts of voice ideas and videos
Push	Expo push service	Delivering notifications to Android and iOS
Observability	Product analytics + error tracking (for example PostHog and Sentry)	Retention funnels, crash reports, job failures

Data model

Postgres is the system of record; the XP ledger is append-only and every other gamification number is derived from it.

Table	Key columns	Notes
users	id, phone, email, birth_date, language, timezone, created_at, deleted_at	Soft delete, then hard delete within 30 days
creator_profiles	user_id, niche, goal, weekly_post_goal, notify_time, coach_tone	One per user
platform_accounts	id, user_id, platform (instagram/youtube), external_id, handle, access_token_enc, refresh_token_enc, token_expires_at, status	Tokens encrypted at rest
ideas	id, user_id, text, stage (idea/hook/script/filmed/posted), embedding, score, created_at	pgvector for duplicate checks

Table	Key columns	Notes
reps	id, user_id, idea_id?, type (hook/script/clip/review/lesson), content, media_url?, status	One row per practice action
ai_feedback	id, rep_id, score, rubric_version, breakdown_json, fix_text, example_text, model, created_at	Structured grading output
posts	id, user_id, platform_account_id, external_media_id, idea_id?, media_type, caption, published_at, permalink	Only posts after connection
post_metrics	post_id, captured_at, snapshot_label (1h/24h/48h/7d/30d), views, likes, comments, saves, shares, watch_time?, retention_json?	One row per snapshot
xp_ledger	id, user_id, amount, reason, source_type, source_id, created_at, reversed_by?	Append-only; reversals are new rows
streaks	user_id, kind (daily/weekly_goal), current, longest, last_counted_date, freezes_held	Recomputed from ledger and posts
skills	user_id, skill, xp, level	Six rows per user
leagues / league_members	league_id, tier, week_start; user_id, weekly_xp, final_rank, outcome	Closed weekly
creator_tiers	user_id, tier, achieved_at, evidence_post_id?	History kept; current = highest
badges / user_badges	badge_id, name, rule; user_id, badge_id, earned_at	
notifications	id, user_id, type, body, scheduled_for, sent_at, opened_at	Enforces daily cap
ai_calls	id, user_id, pipeline, model, input_tokens, output_tokens, cost_inr, latency_ms	Cost tracking

Table	Key columns	Notes
fraud_flags	id, user_id, post_id?, rule, details_json, status	Reviewed in admin

Phase 5 adds: brands, campaigns, campaign_applications, deliverables, contracts, payouts, tax_records.

API surface and background jobs

A REST API under `/v1`, authenticated with the Supabase JWT; the client only ever reads gamification state and never writes it.

Method	Path	Purpose
GET / PATCH	/v1/me	Profile, settings, weekly goal
DELETE	/v1/me	Start account and data deletion
GET	/v1/home	Daily brief, streaks, league snapshot, next pipeline item
GET / POST	/v1/ideas	List or create ideas (text or voice)
PATCH	/v1/ideas/{id}	Move stage, edit text
POST	/v1/reps	Submit a rep; text reps return feedback inline
POST	/v1/reps/{id}/upload-url	Signed upload URL for clips and videos
GET	/v1/reps/{id}	Rep status and feedback (poll for async video review)
GET / POST	/v1/coach/messages	Coach chat history; send a message (streamed reply)
GET	/v1/connect/{platform}/start	Begin OAuth
GET	/v1/connect/{platform}/callback	Finish OAuth, store encrypted tokens
DELETE	/v1/connect/{platform}	Disconnect and revoke
GET	/v1/posts	Detected posts with latest metrics

Method	Path	Purpose
POST	/v1/posts/{id}/link-idea	Link a post to an idea manually
POST	/v1/posts/{id}/reflection	Submit the 48-hour reflection
GET	/v1/progress	XP, skills, tier, badges, personal bests
GET	/v1/leagues/current	Current league table
POST	/v1/devices	Register an Expo push token

Background jobs

Job	Schedule	What it does
sync_new_posts	Every 2 hours per connected account	Finds posts published since the last sync, creates `posts` rows, awards posting XP
snapshot_metrics	Every 15 minutes, picks posts due a snapshot	Captures metrics at 1h, 24h, 48h, 7d, 30d
results_ready	On the 48h snapshot	Runs the results explainer, sends a push, opens the reflection prompt
evaluate_tiers	After each snapshot	Checks milestones and personal bests, runs fraud checks, awards tiers
daily_brief	Nightly per timezone	Generates tomorrow's brief for each active user
streak_rollover	Hourly, per timezone at local midnight	Extends or breaks streaks, applies freezes
close_leagues	Sunday 23:59 IST	Ranks, promotes, demotes, forms next week's cohorts
send_notifications	Every 5 minutes	Sends due pushes within the daily cap and quiet hours
refresh_tokens	Daily	Refreshes long-lived tokens before expiry; marks failures for reconnect
video_review	Queue	The video pipeline in AI pipelines

Every job is idempotent: re-running it for the same window must not double-award XP.

Instagram and YouTube integration

Both platforms give us a creator's own post metrics through official OAuth APIs, so the app never scrapes and never asks for screenshots; the main limits are Instagram's account-type rule and YouTube's daily quota.

Wrap both behind one interface so a third platform can be added later:

```
class PlatformConnector(Protocol):
    def auth_url(self, state: str) -> str: ...
    def exchange_code(self, code: str) -> TokenSet: ...
    def refresh(self, tokens: TokenSet) -> TokenSet: ...
    def get_profile(self, tokens: TokenSet) -> AccountProfile: ...        #
handle, followers
    def list_media_since(self, tokens: TokenSet, since: datetime) ->
list[MediaItem]: ...
    def get_metrics(self, tokens: TokenSet, media_ids: list[str]) ->
list[MetricSnapshot]: ...
```

Instagram (Instagram API with Instagram Login)

Item	Detail
Login	Business Login for Instagram, host `graph.instagram.com`; no Facebook Page needed (Meta)
Permissions	`instagram_business_basic`, `instagram_business_manage_insights` (Meta)
Account type	Only professional accounts (creator or business) return data; onboarding must explain the free switch (Meta)
Reel metrics to store	`views`, `reach`, `likes`, `comments`, `saved`, `shares`, `total_interactions`, `ig_reels_avg_watch_time`, `reels_skip_rate`
Delays	Metric data can lag up to 48 hours; take the 48h snapshot as provisional and the 7-day one as final for tier awards
Webhooks	Insights webhooks are not supported with Instagram Login, so syncing is by polling
Gaps	No insights for media inside carousel albums; story metrics only last 24 hours
Review	Expect Meta App Review before users outside the developer team can connect; plan 2 to 4 weeks for it in Phase 1

`reels_skip_rate` (share of viewers who skipped in the first 3 seconds) is the best signal for hook coaching. Meta marks it estimated and in development, so treat it as optional.

YouTube (Data API v3 + YouTube Analytics API)

Item	Detail
Login	Google OAuth with read-only YouTube and YouTube Analytics scopes
Detect new videos	Read the channel's uploads playlist (cheap list call), or subscribe to YouTube's push notifications for uploads
Metrics	`videos.list` statistics (views, likes, comments), batched up to 50 IDs per call; Analytics API for watch time and retention on the user's own channel
Quota	Default 10,000 units per day for most endpoints, plus separate buckets of 100 `search.list` and 100 `videos.insert` calls; list reads usually cost 1 unit; more quota by request form (Google)

Quota planning: syncing every 2 hours with about 2 list calls per sync is roughly 24 units per user per day, which caps the default quota near 400 connected YouTube users. Use push notifications for new uploads, batch metric reads, and file the quota extension request during Phase 1.

Brand marketplace (Phase 5)

Phase 5 turns brand campaigns into paid quests for Gig-ready creators, with one edge over SideShift-style marketplaces: every creator's skill scores and post metrics come from verified data, not self-reported numbers.

Brand side (web dashboard)

1. Brand signs up, adds GSTIN and PAN, and pastes its website or app store link.
2. AI drafts the brief: product summary, target audience, 3 content angles, deliverables, suggested pay per video.
3. Brand sets eligibility (niche, platform, minimum tier, language, city if needed), budget, deadline and usage rights.

4. The campaign goes live as a quest inside the creator app.
5. Brand reviews applicants with an AI shortlist ranked by fit (this is the original matching algorithm: niche match, audience fit, skill scores, past completion rate).
6. Creators submit drafts; the brand approves or requests one revision round.
7. Creator posts; the app tracks the post through the creator's connected account.
8. Brand approves the deliverable and releases payment.

Creator side (inside the existing app)

- Quests tab, visible only from Gig-ready tier, with a teaser of locked quests for lower tiers as motivation.
- Apply with one tap; the application auto-attaches skill scores and best posts.
- Completing a quest awards large XP, a badge and counts toward a "Pro" tier.

Payments

- Brand pre-funds the campaign budget into escrow before it goes live.
- Payouts to creators by UPI or bank transfer through a payout provider such as RazorpayX or Cashfree Payouts [DECIDE after comparing fees and TDS support].
- The platform deducts TDS where required and issues TDS certificates (see Trust and compliance).
- Platform fee on top of creator pay [DECIDE the percentage].

Campaign analytics for brands

- Views, engagement and cost per thousand views per creator and per campaign, from verified platform data.
- Content angle comparison: which hooks and formats performed best across creators.
- Export of top-performing videos with usage rights for paid ads.

Later ideas (not in scope yet): virality and best-posting-time prediction for brands, an MCP server so brands can run campaigns from an AI assistant, and affiliate or sales-based payouts.

Trust, safety and India compliance

Three rules shape the build: keep the app 18+ until a parental-consent flow exists, never let fake views earn tiers, and settle the TDS setup with a CA before the first brand payout.

Data protection (DPDP Act 2023 and DPDP Rules 2025)

- The Rules were notified on 14 November 2025. Notice and consent, breach reporting, security safeguards, verifiable consent for children's data and user rights take effect on 14 May 2027 (Shardul Amarchand Mangaldas). Build to these from day one.
- Anyone under 18 is a child. Processing their data needs verifiable parental consent, and tracking, behavioural monitoring and targeted ads aimed at children are prohibited. A streak-and-XP app is behavioural monitoring by design, so launch 18+ only.
- Rules also require two-tier breach reporting (to the Data Protection Board and affected users), grievance resolution within 90 days, and keeping processing logs for at least one year.
- Ship a clear consent notice at signup, a data export, account deletion, and a grievance contact.

Platform policies

- Official APIs only; no scraping, no stored passwords.
- When a user disconnects a platform, revoke the token and delete that platform's stored data.
- Follow Meta Platform Terms and YouTube API Services Developer Policies, including their rules on how long API data may be stored.

Ad disclosure (Phase 5): brand quest posts must carry a paid-partnership label in line with ASCI's influencer advertising guidelines. Content review checks for it before approval.

Tax on creator payouts (Phase 5) — confirm every line with a CA before launch (Finowings, updated Jul 2026):

Item	Rule as of Oct 2026
Governing law	Income Tax Act, 2025 replaced the 1961 Act from 1 April 2026; TDS now sits under Section 393(1)
Cash fees to creators	10% TDS above ₹30,000 (formerly Section 194J)
Free products or perks	10% TDS once a brand's benefits to one creator exceed ₹20,000 in a year (formerly Section 194R)
Creator without PAN	TDS at 20%
Paperwork	Quarterly TDS return Form 140; certificate to creator Form 131

Item	Rule as of Oct 2026
GST	18% on promotional services; creator registration mandatory above ₹20 lakh annual turnover

[DECIDE with a CA] whether the platform or the brand is the TDS deductor; that depends on how money flows through escrow. Collect PAN at payout setup either way.

Fraud and integrity

Signal	Rule
View spike	Views far above the creator's own baseline with low reach or low interactions → hold tier award
Engagement ratio	Interactions per view far outside the account's history → flag
Follower jump	Sudden follower gains with no matching post performance → flag
Multiple accounts	Same phone, device ID or payout account across users → block duplicate XP and payouts
Duplicate content	Perceptual hash match against other users' campaign submissions → reject

Tier awards based on views wait for the 7-day snapshot and pass these checks; flagged items go to the admin console.

Safety and security

- Coach guardrails in the persona prompt (see AI pipelines); users can report a bad AI reply.
- No user-to-user messaging in MVP; leagues show display names and avatars only.
- OAuth tokens encrypted at rest, row-level security on every user table, signed short-lived URLs for media.

Build plan

Five phases to a public creator app, then the marketplace as its own phase; each ends with a gate Jash checks before the next starts.

Repo layout

```
apps/mobile        Expo app (TypeScript, Expo Router)
apps/admin         Internal admin web (Next.js)
services/api       FastAPI app
services/worker    Background jobs and video pipeline
packages/shared    API types generated from the FastAPI OpenAPI schema
supabase/          Migrations, seed data, row-level security policies
prompts/           Coach persona and grading rubrics, versioned
config/            gamification.yaml, notifications.yaml
docs/PRD.md        This document
```

Phase 0: Foundations

1. Monorepo, linting, formatting, CI running tests on every push.
2. Supabase project, migrations for `users`, `creator_profiles`, `xp_ledger`, `streaks`.
3. Phone OTP and Google sign-in with the 18+ age gate.
4. FastAPI skeleton with auth middleware, health check, OpenAPI type generation into `packages/shared`.
5. Empty home screen on an Android device via Expo.

- [ ] Gate: Jash signs in on his own Android phone; CI is green; a fresh clone runs with one setup command.

Phase 1: The daily loop (no platform connection yet)

1. Onboarding flow (M2) ending in the first graded hook exercise.
2. Idea pipeline (M3) with text and voice ideas.
3. Text reps (M4): hooks, hook rewrites, scripts, with the grading pipelines and rubric files.
4. XP ledger, daily streak, streak freezes, all driven by `config/gamification.yaml`.
5. Coach v1 (M5): daily brief and feedback voice, English and Hinglish.
6. Push notifications (M8): daily reminder and streak-at-risk.

- [ ] Gate: 10 test users use it daily for 7 days; text feedback returns in under 8 seconds; no way to earn XP from the client.

Phase 2: Real posts and results

1. Instagram and YouTube connectors behind `PlatformConnector`; encrypted tokens; token refresh job.

2. Submit Meta App Review and the YouTube quota extension request at the start of this phase.
3. Post detection, metric snapshots (1h to 30d), the 48-hour results card and reflection.
4. Posting XP, weekly goal streak, creator tiers, personal bests, celebration screens.

- [ ] Gate: on test accounts, a new post is detected within 6 hours and its snapshots match the native app's numbers.

Phase 3: Depth and integrity

1. Practice clip and pre-post video review pipeline.
2. Skill tree, weekly leagues, badges.
3. Fraud checks and the admin console (M10).
4. AI cost tracking, per-user budgets, and the golden-set evaluation for prompts.

- [ ] Gate: closed beta of about 100 users for 4 weeks; AI cost per active user is known and within the budget Jash sets.

Phase 4: Public launch

1. DPDP-ready flows: consent notice, data export, deletion, grievance contact.
2. Product analytics and crash reporting.
3. Play Store and App Store submission.

- [ ] Gate: store approval; north-star and retention dashboards live.

Phase 5: Brand marketplace

Write a dedicated spec from the Brand marketplace section first: payout provider choice, TDS setup confirmed by a CA, escrow flow, and the brand dashboard. Do not start this phase until those are settled.

Open questions for Jash

The first four block Phase 1; the rest can wait until their phase.

- [ ] Final app name (LockIn is a placeholder).
- [ ] Instagram and YouTube at launch, or Instagram only for a faster MVP?
- [ ] Confirm 18+ at launch. Is a parental-consent flow for under-18s worth building later?
- [ ] Coach character: name, personality, and how strict or funny it should be.
- [ ] Languages after English and Hinglish, and in what order.
- [ ] Monthly AI budget per active user.

- [ ] When to introduce any paid tier for creators, if ever.
- [ ] Payout provider and platform fee for the marketplace.
- [ ] With a CA: who deducts TDS on creator payouts, the platform or the brand.

Sources

- SideShift homepage and SideShift for AI, read Oct 2026
- Meta: Instagram Media Insights reference
- Meta: User and Media Insights on Instagram API with Instagram Login
- Meta: IG Media reference
- Google: YouTube Data API overview and quota
- Shardul Amarchand Mangaldas: DPDP Act enforcement and DPDP Rules alert, Nov 2025
- Finowings: Influencer tax in India, updated Jul 2026